After reaching Salim's court, Salima Sultan sent happy tidings of her mission. She assured Akbar that she had 'cleansed the stain of savagery and suspicion from his heart' and that she was bringing his son back to Agra. As the penitent convoy reached the capital, Salim sent a message begging that his grandmother Hamida Banu be sent out to accompany him into his father's presence. No doubt Salim believed that in view of the abhorrent assassination of Abu'l Fazl, he would require the sacred protection of the Padshah's mother herself. With Hamida Banu guiding him by the hand, Salim came into his father's presence and threw himself at the Padshah's feet. Akbar hugged his son and placed his own turban upon the prince's head but things had changed irrevocably between them and it appeared that Akbar found it hard to truly forgive his son for his latest unforgivable crime. Salim offered his father a peshkash of 12,000 mohurs and 977 elephants, of which Akbar accepted only 350, a subtle sign of his icy displeasure. When Abu'l Fazl's brother and son appeared at court soon after, to lay their grief and their tears at the Padshah's feet, in addition to a peshkash of three elephants, four swords, seven strings of pearls and decorated vessels, the atmosphere must have turned distinctly uncomfortable for the prince. Not long after, Salim left Agra, ostensibly to pursue the Rana of Udaipur, but instead went to Fatehpur Sikri, and asked his father's permission to return to Allahabad. This Akbar was constrained to do and Salim proceeded to Allahabad, 'joyfully, drinking wine, and pleasuring himself '.

Despite his fervent commitment to enjoying himself with wine and song, grief entered Salim's house. Khusrau's mother, the Rajput princess Shah Begum, daughter of Bhagwant Das, grew weary of the atmosphere of suspicion and hostility between her son and her husband. Khusrau, bolstered by the support of the powerful Kachhwahas including Shah Begum's brother, Man Singh, had become a tangible alternative to those looking for a Padshah to succeed Akbar, and Shah Begum was undone. 'She constantly wrote to Khusrau,' said Jahangir in his memoirs, 'and urged him to be sincere and affectionate to me. When she saw that it was of no use and that it was unknown how far he would be led away, she from the indignation and high spirit which are inherent in the Rajput character determined upon death.' Unable to live the life of unstained honour she had promised herself, Shah Begum took opium and embraced the immortality that the Rajput code demanded of her. 'Several times she went berserk,'